Product Support & Operations Playbook — 2026

Synthetic operational knowledge-base document for multi-document RAG testing.

Document Metadata

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Support Service Levels

Priority P1 — Critical

A widespread outage, complete service unavailability, or security event with immediate customer impact is P1. Target first response is 15 minutes. The incident coordinator should provide status updates at least every 30 minutes while the incident remains active.

Priority P2 — High

A major feature is unavailable or a significant customer workflow is impaired without a full platform outage. Target first response is 1 hour. Status updates should normally occur every 2 hours.

Priority P3 — Normal

A limited functional issue, workaround request, or non-critical defect affecting a small number of users. Target first response is 8 business hours.

Priority P4 — Low

General questions, documentation requests, cosmetic issues, and enhancement suggestions. Target first response is 2 business days.

Release Management

Standard Release

Standard production releases use an approved deployment plan, automated validation, monitoring, and a rollback procedure. The release owner records the release identifier and deployment outcome.

Emergency Change

Emergency changes may bypass selected standard lead-time requirements when necessary to mitigate an active production incident or critical security vulnerability. The change must still be documented and reviewed retrospectively.

Rollback

A rollback should be initiated when post-deployment signals indicate unacceptable customer impact, data integrity risk, or sustained error-rate degradation. Rollback criteria should be defined before deployment.

Observability and Reliability

Golden Signals

Service teams should monitor latency, traffic, errors, and saturation. These signals provide a baseline for identifying service degradation.

Alerting

Alerts should be actionable and linked to an operational response. Alert thresholds should avoid excessive noise while detecting material customer-impacting conditions.

SLOs

Services may define service-level objectives for availability and latency. Error budgets can be used to balance feature delivery with reliability investment.

Incident Metrics

Post-incident analysis should consider time to detect, time to acknowledge, time to mitigate, time to recover, and recurrence rate.

Customer Data Handling

Data Minimization

Support teams should request only the customer information necessary to investigate an issue. Sensitive credentials should never be requested through ordinary support channels.

Case Notes

Support notes should describe observable symptoms, troubleshooting steps, relevant timestamps, and resolution status. Avoid copying unnecessary personal or confidential information.

Access

Customer records should be accessible only to personnel whose role requires access. Access should follow the organization's identity and authorization controls.

Knowledge Base and Escalation

Knowledge Articles

Resolved issues with repeatable troubleshooting steps should be converted into knowledge-base articles. Articles should include symptoms, affected versions, diagnosis, resolution, and escalation criteria.

Engineering Escalation

Escalate to engineering when the issue requires source-code investigation, a production configuration change, a suspected data-integrity problem, or a reproducible defect without an available workaround.

Product Escalation

Escalate to Product Management when the request concerns roadmap decisions, feature prioritization, product behavior that is intentionally designed, or a recurring enhancement request.